

Those who didn't make it

In this comparison test, we tried our best to procure all the branded computers available in the market. In spite of our continued efforts, we missed out on brands such as Dell, IBM and Acer. Each of them had varied reasons for not being able to participate in this comparison test, which we respected.

IBM was unable to participate in the test saying that they were uncomfortable with a comparison test between the leading brands of the country.

ACER readily agreed to send their systems of different configurations, only if we carried individual reviews on each of them and did not do a comparison test.

Dell could not participate because their PCs are built as per customer-requests and only after confirmed orders would they bring them from Singapore. This entire process would take around a month or a little over.

Minicomp stated logistic problems for the absence of their PC in our comparison test.

The last brand was **Cerebra**—in spite of repeatedly calling them, we were unable to elicit a suitable response. Hence, they were omitted from the test.



today, an entry-level soundcard such as the Sound Blaster Live! 5.1 DE (available for under Rs 3,000) has the processing power of a 133 MHz Pentium processor and has full Dolby Digital support to boot! A Pentium 4 at 1.8 GHz or an Athlon XP 1800+ processor is now capable of handling tasks that would have required tens of yesteryears' computers to execute in the same amount of time. This explosive advancement in hardware has naturally spawned a whole new generation of usage patterns. Conversely, the usage pattern itself determines the system configurations you need.

Features

One of the most appealing factors in a PC is the type and quality of the components it features. We noted the specifications of the processor, the amount and type of RAM, hard disk, motherboard, etc. We also considered the ease with which a computer could be upgraded and we evaluated the build quality of the system.

System configuration: All the systems were either based on SDRAM or DDR RAM platforms; we did not receive any RDRAM-based systems. Also, seven of the 12 systems were based upon the integrated graphics core of the 845G or 845GL Intel chipsets; we did not receive any based on AMD processors. In terms of system specifications, the system that stood out from the others was the Visualan Lavish. Its core components consisted of a 2.53 GHz Pentium 4 and a 40 GB 7,200-rpm Seagate Barracuda hard disk, with 256 MB of DDR RAM. The video graphics system was also robust, with the ATi Radeon 7500 driving a 17-inch LG Flatron monitor. The Visualan Lavish was also the only system that featured a CD-RW drive with a 32x write speed capability. To help alleviate the clutter on your desktop, this system also featured a wireless mouse.

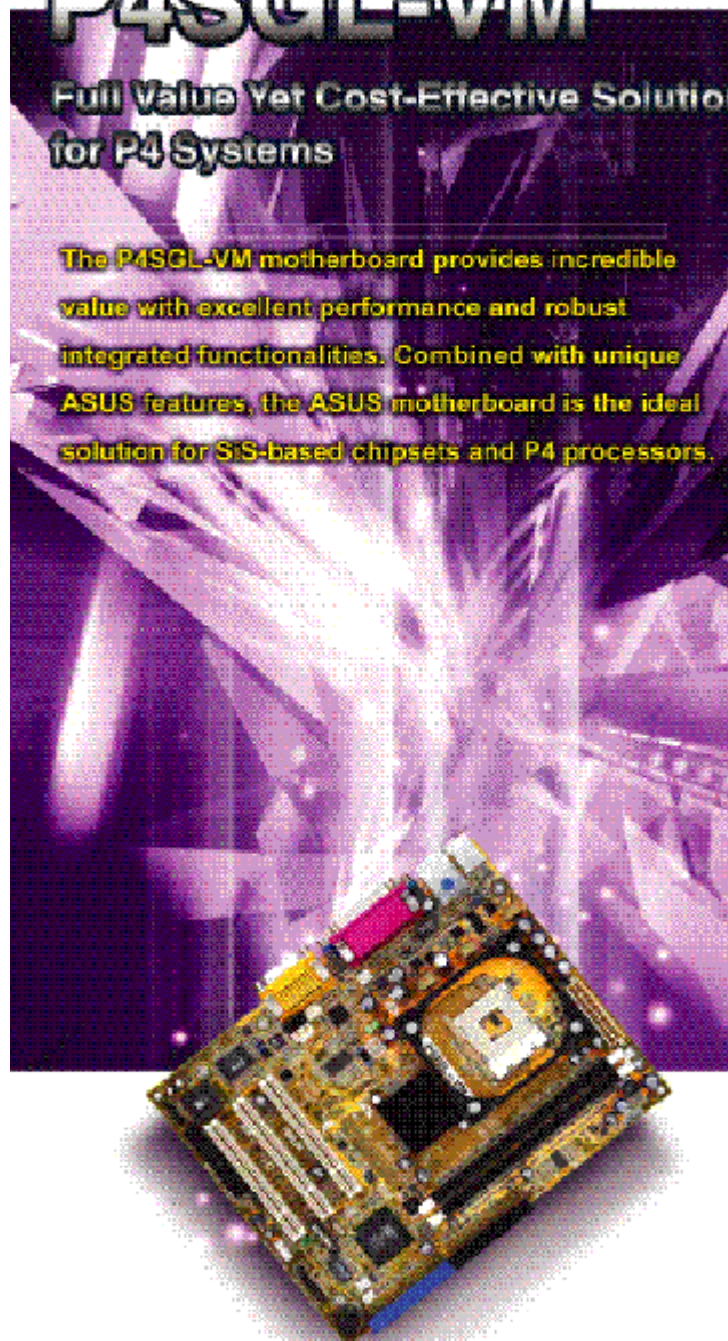
Another noteworthy PC was the HCL Beanstalk 4455. This computer was based upon a 2.4 GHz Pentium 4 with 256 MB of DDR RAM and featured an ASUS V8170 Magic graphics card with 64 MB of DDR video RAM. However, its high point was the two 40 GB 7,200-rpm Seagate Barracuda hard disk drives that were configured in RAID-0 on the onboard Promise ATA/100 IDE RAID



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